Implications of Détente

The crux of the matter is that shifts in the policy produced results as relations between the Soviets and Americans 'normalized'. Détente was marked by several major visits, cultural exchanges, trade agreements, joint technological ventures and, obviously arms reduction endeavours, in place of threats, warnings and confrontations.

Détente witnessed several developments such as the following:

1. Immediately after the Cuban Missile Crisis, a "hotline" was installed in 1963 linking the White House and the Kremlin.
2. The Partial Test Ban Treaty was signed in 1963, the Outer Space Treaty was signed in 1967, and the Nuclear Non-Proliferation Treaty (NPT) was signed in 1968. The Sea-Bed Pact banned the testing of nuclear devices on the bottom of the world's oceans in 1971, and a year later, the Biological Warfare Treaty aimed at curbing the use of biological agents for the purpose of war.
3. Nixon's visit to Moscow in 1972 culminated in the signing of the Strategic Arms Limitation Talks (SALT). The talks produced two agreements: The first in 1972, known as the SALT I, and the second in 1979, called SALT II. However, the SALT II Agreement was never ratified by the United States due to strong congressional opposition.
4. A number of agreements pertaining to trade, agriculture, oceanography, economic and culture followed. In 1973,Brezhnev paid a visit to Washington. The newly elected US President, Gerald Ford also visited Russia and in Vladivostok there was a US–Soviet Agreement on guidelines for arms control and reduction.
5. In Europe, détente culminated symbolically with the Conference on Security and Cooperation in Europe (CSCE) in Helsinki in August 1975. It was attended by 34 countries of Europe and North America and formulated certain agreed principles regarding the relationship between the states of the two blocs. Though nothing concrete was achieved, yet it contributed to the easing of tensions.